



a AI Highlight ▾

Introduction

Trauma can be over and the body can still be doing it. You know you are safe, but you are bracing, scanning, going numb, collapsing, freezing, or suddenly flooding anyway. That is the part of trauma I am interested in here.

With complex or developmental trauma I usually do not begin by asking for the deepest memory. I want to know whether I can stay with what comes up without disappearing, whether I can stop, and whether I can be basically myself again afterward. If not, I would rather work on that than call overwhelm “deep processing.”

Sometimes that means regulation. Sometimes it means giving accumulated survival activation some way to move instead of trying to think your way out of a body that is still acting as if the danger is present. And sometimes there is enough stability to go straight to EMDR or another trauma-focused method. These are not steps in a program; they solve different problems at different times.

The inner-child connection is one reason I care about the body so much. Sometimes you can understand exactly what a younger part needs and still be unable to reach it because your whole system is clenched around the trauma. The body may need to become a little easier to inhabit before inner-child therapy stops feeling like being swallowed by the child-state.

Your Physical State Can Change What Therapy Does

Whether a somatic therapy works well can depend a lot on what else is going on in your body. Keep in mind that poor sleep, pain, inflammation, dissociation, medications, and so forth can all change how you respond. If the therapy suddenly stops doing much, that doesn't necessarily mean you need a different therapy. Sometimes the physical problem is the thing you need to deal with first.

I have seen friends get very little from these therapies until they addressed physical neuroinflammation with things like low-dose naltrexone, phosphatidylserine, DMSO, and so on. In my own experience, I cannot do real healing work when I feel like I have toxins in my gut. Ozonated zeolite helps that a lot. Ozonated charcoal water also helps me when I am surrounded by chaotic energy fields, whether EMF or auric.

I think of that as neurological de-armoring: not another trauma technique, but part of the physical



Overview



Detail